



“Five out of six learners get positive career growth, thus establishing the credibility and mettle of the online higher education and skilling segment in India and globally”

MAYANK KUMAR
CO-FOUNDER AND MD, UPGRAD



TOP 5 COLLABORATIONS

EDTECH	SOME UNIVERSITY COLLABORATIONS
UPGRAD	Golden Gate University, Deakin Business School, Liverpool Business School, BIMTECH
COURSERA	IIT Roorkee, IIM Ahmedabad, University of Illinois Gies College of Business, S.P. Jain Institute of Management & Research
NULEARN	IIM Raipur
GREAT LEARNING	Southern Connecticut State University, Walsh College, People's Education Society University
EMERITUS	Indian School of Business, IIM Lucknow, IIM Kozhikode, IIM Calcutta, IIM Indore

SOURCE BT RESEARCH

CONSTANT IMPROVEMENT

Edtech firms are aware of some of the shortcomings in the MBAs they offer, but they are constantly improving what is on offer. This they do by seeking feedback from students who are undergoing courses and those who have completed them.

Besides, they are also constantly on the lookout for better partner universities. That is evident in the fact that edtech firms have partnered with the elite IIMs to offer an estimated 600 courses on various topics. This is important because the return on investment, calculated as a ratio of the average course fee and average domestic salary, of the top B-schools in India has seen a considerable dip in the BT-MDRA survey this year.

One example of edtech engagement with students is a survey conducted by UNext Learning, which offers a global MBA in collaboration with the Swiss School of Business and Management Geneva. It found that 62% of alumni reported that they saw an improvement in their overall job performance, 78% expressed a deep sense of personal accomplishment, and 61% felt empowered to take on leadership initiatives at work.

upGrad, which has topped the BT-MDRA ranking

in the edtech category, claims that learners of the programmes it offers come at an average salary of ₹8 lakh per annum, and once they complete the course get high increments, about 50-55% in some cases, potentially delivering better ROI than traditional colleges.

Mayank Kumar, upGrad's Co-founder and MD, explains that the edtech unicorn has adopted a blended approach of 30% live class experiences and 70% recorded lectures, alongside industry-driven assignments, quizzes, games, and group projects to improve outcomes. “This comprehensive approach ensures that our learners receive the most up-to-date and practical education, preparing them effectively for the job market,” Kumar notes. He says the programme has an 80% completion rate and a 30% referral rate year on year.

He says learners also achieve significant milestones, such as promotions or new job roles, within six to 12 months after completing the programmes. “Additionally, five out of six learners get positive career growth, thus establishing the credibility and mettle of the online higher education and skilling segment in India and globally,” Kumar adds.

Like regular B-schools, these firms also rope in industry leaders to prepare students for the job market,